

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	APSS1202
Subject Title	Living in an Ageing World: Opportunities in Our Shared Future
Credit Value	1
Level	1
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	The objective of the subject is to prepare students for an ageing society by understanding demographic changes and their impacts, fostering meaningful interactions with older individuals, and exploring opportunities in ageing-related industries and careers.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. Explain population ageing and how demographic changes influence individuals, families, and societies. b. Develop a holistic understanding of ageing as a biological, psychological, and social process. c. Demonstrate empathy, age-inclusiveness, and problem-solving skills in addressing ageing-related challenges. d. Identify opportunities and innovative solutions in ageing societies, including in healthcare, social policy, gerontechnology, and the silver economy.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. Introduction to Population Ageing • Trends and causes of population ageing • Impacts of population ageing on society • Intergenerational Activity: “Getting to Know an Older Friend” 2. The Multifaceted Ageing Process • Ageing as a biological, psychological, and social process • Older adults in family and society 3. Age Inclusiveness: Awareness and Practices • Recognizing ageism in daily life and the workplace • Practices for an age-inclusive society

	4. Industries and Careers in an Ageing Future - Exploring disciplines and careers in ageing-related fields - Skills for effective communication and working with older adults 5. Designing Solutions for Older Adults - Identifying challenges in an ageing society and addressing the needs of older adults - Group project presentations on innovative solutions																																		
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	This subject introduces students to key issues in a rapidly ageing world, encouraging them to reflect on the relevance of these topics to their personal development and future careers. Through lectures, group projects, reflections and intergenerational interactions with older adults, students from multiple disciplines will gain real-world exposure and mutual understanding, fostering empathy and awareness of the challenges and opportunities in an ageing society.																																		
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="4">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th></tr><tr><td>1. Participation</td><td>20%</td><td>√</td><td>√</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2. Group Project Presentation</td><td>20%</td><td></td><td></td><td>√</td><td>√</td></tr><tr><td>3. Personal Reflection</td><td>60%</td><td>√</td><td>√</td><td>√</td><td>√</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="4"></td></tr></table> Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: 1. Participation Students are expected to actively engage in lectures and class activities to achieve the learning objectives through dedicated learning and a commitment to professional growth and leadership in the field of ageing. 2. Group Project Presentation Students are expected to work in groups to identify an ageing-related issue that reflects the needs of the older population during the course period. They should demonstrate their understanding of the ageing situation, the ageing population, and age-inclusive practices. Groups need to provide a	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				a	b	c	d	1. Participation	20%	√	√			2. Group Project Presentation	20%			√	√	3. Personal Reflection	60%	√	√	√	√	Total	100 %				
Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting			Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)																															
		a	b	c	d																														
1. Participation	20%	√	√																																
2. Group Project Presentation	20%			√	√																														
3. Personal Reflection	60%	√	√	√	√																														
Total	100 %																																		

	multidisciplinary solution to address the issues. By the last lecture, students are expected to deliver a presentation, during which older adults will participate in discussions to evaluate the appropriateness of their observations, understanding, and proposed solutions. 3. Personal Reflection After each lecture, students are expected to complete a personal reflection diary to express their understanding, attitudes, and feelings about the course content. Through these individual reflection activities, students are encouraged to deeply consider how they can find their place in ageing and society, and how they can adapt to and contribute to an ageing world. They are expected to better align and connect their future development (e.g. discipline, industry, or career choices) with the realities of an ageing world.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures	13 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Self-directed study	15 Hrs.
	▪ After-class reflection diaries	5 Hrs.
	▪ Preparation for group projects	5 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	38 Hrs.
Reading List and References	1) Census and Statistics Department HKSAR. (2023). <i>2021 Population Census Thematic Report: Older Persons</i>. https://www.census2021.gov.hk/doc/pub/21c-older-persons.pdf 2) Dziechciaż, M., & Filip, R. (2014). Biological psychological and social determinants of old age: bio-psycho-social aspects of human aging. <i>Annals of agricultural and environmental medicine: AAEM</i>, 21(4), 835–838. https://doi.org/10.5604/12321966.1129943 3) Silverstein, M., & Giarrusso, R. (2010). Aging and family life: A decade review. <i>Journal of Marriage and Family</i>, 72(5), 1039-1058. 4) World Health Organization. (2021). Global report on ageism. 5) Fitzgerald, K. G., & Caro, F. G. (2014). An overview of age-friendly cities and communities around the world. <i>Journal of aging & social policy</i>, 26(1-2), 1-18. 6) Architectural Services Department HKSAR. (2019). <i>Elderly-friendly Design Guidelines</i>. https://www.archsd.gov.hk/media/reports/practices-and-	

	guidelines/20190326_5501_Elderly-friendly%20Design%20Guidelines_FINAL.pdf 7) Kohlbacher, F., Herstatt, C., & Schweisfurth, T. (2010). Product development for the silver market. In <i>The Silver Market Phenomenon: Marketing and Innovation in the Aging Society</i> (pp. 3-13). Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg. 8) Carrillo-Alvarez, E., Rodríguez-Monforte, M., Fernández-Jané, C., Solà-Madurell, M., Kozakiewicz, M., Głowacka, M., ... & Grüneberg, C. (2023). Professional competences to promote healthy ageing across the lifespan: a scoping review. <i>European journal of ageing</i>, 20(1), 45.
--	--

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020